# EW 20 ADVERBS

## 119. ADVERBS

Formation of adverbs

a) **from adjectives ending in a vowel** : take the masculine form and add *-ment*

vrai + *ment: vraiment* absolu + *ment: absolument*

b) **from most adjectives ending in a consonant** : take feminine form and add *-ment*

heureux → *heureuse* → *heureusement* essentiel → *essentielle* → *essentiellement*

c) **from adjectives ending *-ant*/*-ent*** : remove *-ant/-ent* and add *-amment/-emment*

constant → *const* → *constamment* évident → *évid* → *évidemment*

d) some common exceptions

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *gai* | **gaiement** | *aveugle* | **aveuglément** | *énorme* | **énormément** |
| *gentil* | **gentiment** | *commun* | **communément** | *précis* | **précisément** |
| *bref* | **brièvement** | *confus* | **confusément** | *profond* | **profondément** |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Note also | *bien* | is the adverb | *bon* | is the adjective |
| | *mieux* | is the adverb | *meilleur* | is the adjective |
| | *vite* or *rapidement* mean "quickly" | | *rapide* | is the adjective |

## 120. Adverbs never agree : they are always INVARIABLE

Note very carefully the spelling of the following adverbs which never change

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **environ** | approximately | **ensemble** | together |
| **tout de suite** | at once/immediately | **tout à l'heure** | in a minute/just now |

### 121. Sometimes adjectives are used as adverbs. In this case they do not agree with the subject of the verb

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| to be expensive | **coûter cher** | to see clearly | **voir clair** |
| to talk loudly | **parler fort** | to work hard | **travailler dur** |
| to talk quietly | **parler bas** | to fall thickly (rain, leaves etc.) | **tomber dru** |
| to be heavy | **peser lourd** | | |
| to smell nice | **sentir bon** | to sing out of tune | **chanter faux** |
| to smell nasty | **sentir mauvais** | | |

*Ils parlaient fort* *Elle sent mauvais* *Les feuilles tombaient dru*

## 122. Position

a) adverbs NEVER come between a subject and a verb

b) *tout, mieux, bien, beaucoup, tant, trop, tous* all stand

- **before an infinitive** : *pour mieux voir; je dois tout faire*
- **before a past participle** : *elle a tout vu; il a bien joué; j'ai trop bu*

c) common short adverbs (*toujours, souvent, déjà, encore*) always stand between the auxiliary and the past participle

*J'ai toujours pensé que .....; je leur ai souvent dit que . . .*

d) Note the fixed order of the following negatives + adverbs:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| not yet | **ne . . .pas encore** | *elle n'est pas encore arrivée* |
| not even | **ne . . .même pas** | *je ne les ai même pas vu(e)s* |
| still not | **ne . . .toujours pas** | *ils ne les ont toujours pas lu(e)s* |

e) emphatic adverbs of time often stand at the beginning of a phrase : *soudain il l'a vu devant lui*

## 123. Always be alert to the possibility that English ". . . .ly" adverbs might best be rendered by an adverbial phrase introduced by de. The possibilities are:

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| - speech | **d'une voix . . .**<br>**d'un ton . . .** | look/expression | **d'un air . . .** |
| - gait | **d'un pas . . .** | manner | **d'une manière/ d'une façon** |

*Il a parlé d'un ton bizarre* *Elle a marché d'un pas vif*

## 124. Some important points

- even more + adverb : **encore plus + adverb** (NEVER *même plus*)
- in a ----- way : **d'une façon / d'une manière . . .**

## 125. faire + INFINITIVE

When one verb is followed by another, the second verb is ALWAYS an INFINITIVE.

Note the word order:

| | |
|---|---|
| *faire* + INFINITIVE + NOUN | *Je ferai peindre la maison* |
| PRONOUN + *faire* + INFINITIVE | *Je la ferai peindre* |

a) To convey the idea of "having something done" or "getting something done"

| | |
|---|---|
| I had the car repaired | *J'ai fait réparer la voiture* |
| I will get this letter signed | *Je ferai signer cette lettre* |

N.B. There is no PDO agreement on the past participle of *faire* when it is used in this way.

| | |
|---|---|
| (The car) I have had it repaired | *(La voiture) Je l'ai fait réparer* |

If the subject of the verb is getting something done to himself, herself or themselves *faire* becomes reflexive. Note that there is no agreement of the past participle, just as in (a) above

| | |
|---|---|
| She had her hair cut | *Elle s'est fait couper les cheveux* |

b) To convey the idea of "making someone do" something:

1. When the following infinitive DOES NOT HAVE a direct object or a dependent *que* clause, *faire* takes a direct object (pronouns: *me, te, le, la, nous, vous, les*)

| | |
|---|---|
| I made her forget | *Je l'ai fait oublier* (no agreement) |
| I made my mother sing | *J'ai fait chanter ma mère* |

2. When the following infinitive DOES HAVE a direct object or a dependent *que* clause, *faire* takes an indirect construction (pronouns *me, te lui, nous, vous, leur*)

| | |
|---|---|
| I made her forget her worries | *Je **lui** ai fait oublier ses soucis* |
| I made her forget she had any worries | *Je **lui** ai fait oublier qu'elle avait des soucis* |
| I made my mother sing a song | *J'ai fait chanter une chanson à ma mère* |

c) "To make oneself" + PAST PARTICIPLE

*se faire* + INFINITIVE

| | |
|---|---|
| They made themselves heard | *Ils se sont fait entendre* |
| She made herself obeyed | *Elle s'est fait obéir* |
| We made ourselves understood | *Nous nous sommes fait comprendre* |